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BSc (Hons) Information Technology specialized in Information Technology
Final Year

Sri Lanka Institute of Information Technology (SLIIT)

Professional Portfolio

Preparing for Professional World (PPW) | SLIIT

Intern | Managed Infrastructure Department | MillenniumIT ESP

Former Intern | Bank of Ceylon

May 2026 | Colombo, Sri Lanka

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1. Professional Introduction

My name is Haritha Layomin and I am a final-year BSc (Hons) Information Technology student at SLIIT. Over the past three years, my interests have gradually shifted from writing application code to understanding the infrastructure that sits underneath enterprise systems. That shift did not come from a single decision. It grew through the projects I took on, the internships I completed, and the environments I was exposed to along the way.

In my earlier years, most of my energy went into development. I built a Student Portal using the MERN stack, where I handled the database design, the back-end logic, and the front-end interface from start to finish. I also developed a Gem and Jewelry Management System in PHP, which needed to support real transactional workflows across multiple users. Through those projects, I started to notice how much the reliability of an application depends on what is running beneath it. The servers, the network, the identity systems, and the way everything is managed day to day turned out to be just as interesting to me as the code itself.

That growing interest led me to pursue an internship in infrastructure. Since November 2025, I have been working as an intern in the Digital Infrastructure Department at MillenniumIT ESP. Over the past six months, I have worked with Active Directory, endpoint management tools, and a range of internal infrastructure systems, gaining real exposure to how enterprise IT environments are maintained and secured. In May 2026, I transferred to the Managed Infrastructure Services Department, where I am just getting started and looking forward to building on what I have already learned.

Before MillenniumIT ESP, I interned at the Bank of Ceylon, where I got an early look at how IT is managed inside a regulated, high-stakes environment. That experience gave me a sense of how important process, discipline, and accountability are in professional IT work, well before I had the technical depth to fully understand why.

Looking ahead, Microsoft Azure is the area I want to develop most seriously. I have not yet had formal training in Azure, but it is the next clear step in the direction I am heading. My plan is to earn the AZ-900 and then the AZ-104 certification over the coming year, and to grow steadily into a cloud infrastructure role where I can combine my development background with operational expertise.

2. Reflective Journal: Gibbs Reflective Cycle

The Gibbs Reflective Cycle is a framework I find genuinely useful because it pushes me to go beyond just describing what happened and actually think about why it mattered and what I would do differently. Each of the three entries below focuses on a different area of professional growth, drawn from real situations during my internship and studies.

2.1 Entry One: Communication

Situation: Communicating My Role Transfer at MillenniumIT ESP

Description	In May 2026, after six months in the Digital Infrastructure Department at MillenniumIT ESP, I was transferred to the Managed Infrastructure Services Department. The move happened at the end of my infrastructure placement, which meant I needed to wrap up my responsibilities, communicate the status of ongoing tasks to the relevant people, and prepare myself to step into a new environment where I had no established context yet.
Feelings	I felt a mix of things. There was some uncertainty about leaving a team I had settled into and starting fresh somewhere new. At the same time, I was motivated by the idea of expanding my exposure. The part I found most challenging was communicating my handover clearly without a formal structure in place to guide it.
Evaluation	I put together a written summary of my active tasks and flagged anything that still needed follow-up before I left the team. That was the part that worked best. What I would do differently is have a face-to-face conversation alongside the document, because written notes alone do not always carry the full context of why something is in a particular state.
Analysis	Reflecting on it, I realised there is an important difference between transferring information and transferring understanding. A document can record what was done, but the reasoning behind decisions and the informal knowledge built up over months is harder to capture. In infrastructure work especially, that context often matters a great deal.
Conclusion	I concluded that communication around transitions is not just a courtesy. It is a professional responsibility. The quality of a handover directly affects whether the next person can continue smoothly or has to spend time rebuilding knowledge that already existed.
Action Plan	Going forward, I plan to keep a running task log throughout any placement so that a handover is never built from memory under time pressure. I also want to get more comfortable with structured verbal briefings, where I can check for understanding rather than assuming a document is sufficient.

2.2 Entry Two: Leadership

Situation: Leading the AI-Powered Dyslexia Screening Research Project

Description	While working as a full-time intern at MillenniumIT ESP, I was also leading my final year research project at SLIIT. The project involved building an AI-powered dyslexia screening tool using machine learning and natural language processing. As the lead, I was responsible for coordinating the team, managing the timeline, keeping the work aligned with our supervisor's guidance, and making sure the overall quality stayed at an academic standard throughout.
Feelings	Managing both at the same time was genuinely demanding. There were periods where deadlines from the internship and the research project would land at the same time, and I had to make quick judgement calls about where to focus. What kept me going was the subject matter. Building something that could help identify learning difficulties in children earlier felt like work worth doing, and that sense of purpose made the harder stretches more manageable.
Evaluation	We reached a working prototype with measurable accuracy results, which I am proud of. The team stayed together and produced good work. Where I fell short was in how I distributed responsibilities at the beginning. I held on to too much myself early on, which put unnecessary pressure on me and slowed down some parts of the project.
Analysis	The experience taught me that leading a team is as much about enabling other people as it is about doing the work yourself. When I eventually delegated more clearly, the team performed better, and I was less stretched. I also noticed that being transparent with the team about progress and blockers, even when things were not going perfectly, built more trust than trying to manage everything quietly.
Conclusion	I came away with a clearer sense of what effective leadership looks like in practice. It is not about being the most capable person in the room. It is about creating the conditions for the people around you to do their best work, which requires communication, clarity, and a willingness to let go of control at the right moments.
Action Plan	I want to study Agile methodology more seriously and apply it in future team projects, because I think the structure of regular check-ins and defined roles would have helped us a lot. I also plan to look for mentoring opportunities in my next role, as teaching others is one of the more effective ways to develop as a leader.

2.3 Entry Three: Ethics and Professional Responsibility

Situation: Handling Sensitive Systems in the Digital Infrastructure Department

Description	During my six months in the Digital Infrastructure Department at MillenniumIT ESP, I was given access to systems that carry real responsibility. This included working with Active Directory user accounts and handling endpoint management tasks for corporate devices. These are not trivial tools. Active Directory controls who can access what across the organization, and mistakes at that level can affect many people at once.
Feelings	When I first understood the scope of what I had access to, I felt the weight of it quite strongly. Being an intern did not reduce the potential impact of an error. I was aware from early on that the trust placed in me was not symbolic. It was operational, and that shaped how carefully I approached every task involving those systems.
Evaluation	Throughout the placement, I made a point of checking with my supervisor before acting on anything involving user accounts or device configurations, even when I technically had the permissions to proceed on my own. That caution occasionally slowed things down, but it was the right approach. Nothing went wrong as a result of my actions during the internship.
Analysis	This experience brought the principle of least privilege out of the lecture slides and into reality. I had encountered it in security modules at SLIIT but applying it in a live enterprise setting made it concrete in a way that studying alone never could. I also thought a lot about the nature of insider risk during this period. The risk is not always from bad actors. It often comes from well-meaning people who act without fully understanding the consequences, and I did not want to be that person.
Conclusion	I left the Digital Infrastructure placement with a genuine conviction that ethical IT practice is active, not passive. It requires you to slow down, question your assumptions, and respect the trust that has been placed in you. That is true whether you are an intern or a senior engineer, and it is something I want to carry into every role I take on.
Action Plan	I plan to study data governance and information security ethics more formally as I progress in my career. I also want to advocate for proper access review processes and privacy-conscious design in any team I am part of, because having seen it matter in practice, I understand why those safeguards exist.

3. Career Development Plan: Three-Year Roadmap

The plan below sets out where I want to be over the next three years and what I intend to do to get there. Each year has a clear goal, the skills I need to develop, the steps I will take, and a way of measuring whether I have succeeded.

Year	Goal	Skills to Acquire	Action Steps	Success Metric
Year 1 2026 to 2027	Graduate from SLIIT and earn the AZ-900 and AZ-104 Microsoft Azure certifications	Azure fundamentals, virtual networking, identity and access management, compute and storage, Azure governance and monitoring	Complete Microsoft Learn AZ-900 path and sit the exam; follow up with the AZ-104 study path; set up a personal Azure free-tier lab; apply learnings directly in the Managed Services role at MillenniumIT ESP	BSc (Hons) degree awarded; AZ-900 certificate obtained; AZ-104 examination sat by end of Year 1
Year 2 2027 to 2028	Secure a permanent Associate Infrastructure or Cloud Engineer role and pursue CCNA	Network routing and switching, Azure hybrid connectivity including VPN and ExpressRoute, ITIL service management, scripting for automation using PowerShell or Python	Apply to infrastructure and cloud engineer graduate programmes; self-study CCNA through Cisco NetAcad; shadow senior network engineers; complete ITIL 4 Foundation as a supporting credential	Full-time employment offer accepted; CCNA passed; on track for mid-level grade within 12 months of joining
Year 3 2028 to 2029	Build expertise in cloud architecture and take ownership of hybrid cloud deployment work	Azure Solutions Architecture (AZ-305), infrastructure as code using Terraform or Bicep, FinOps cost management, disaster recovery design, multi-cloud awareness	Pursue AZ-305 certification; lead at least one enterprise cloud migration project; present at an internal knowledge-sharing session; begin mentoring junior team members	AZ-305 achieved; recognised as technical lead on at least one cloud project; measurable improvement in cost or performance documented

4. Curriculum Vitae: Experience and Skills

Professional Experience

IT Intern, Digital Infrastructure Department | MillenniumIT ESP

November 2025 to April 2026 | Colombo, Sri Lanka

- Administered Active Directory user accounts, organizational unit structures, and group policy objects within a large enterprise environment, following least-privilege access principles throughout.
- Managed endpoint configurations and supported BitLocker Drive Encryption across the corporate device fleet, maintaining accurate records of device status and recovery information.
- Assisted with network infrastructure tasks including IP address management, VLAN documentation, and coordinating with senior engineers on configuration changes.
- Maintained IT asset records, contributing to the department's audit-readiness by improving the accuracy and consistency of documentation.
- Supported day-to-day reporting by keeping structured operational logs and assisting the team with internal IT governance processes.

IT Intern, Managed Services Department | MillenniumIT ESP

May 2026 to Present | Colombo, Sri Lanka

- Recently transferred to the Managed Services Department as part of a planned rotation within the internship programme.
- Currently in the early stages of onboarding and familiarising with the team's operational scope, workflows, and service delivery responsibilities.

IT Intern | Bank of Ceylon

May 2025 to Nov 2025 | Colombo, Sri Lanka

- Maintained IT operations within a regulated financial environment, strictly adhering to bank-grade information security and data handling protocols.
- Administered user access workflows via Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) to ensure full compliance with internal audit requirements.
- Standardized technical documentation and knowledge base entries, reducing resolution times for recurring infrastructure and end-user issues.
- Executed domain configurations and IP assignments for new workstations, ensuring seamless integration into the corporate network.

Academic Projects

Lead Developer: Student Portal | SLIIT Academic Project | 2023

MERN Stack

- Designed and built a full-stack academic management portal with role-based dashboards for students, lecturers, and administrators.
- Developed a RESTful API covering authentication using JWT, attendance tracking, and grade management modules.

Lead Developer: Gem and Jewelry Management System | SLIIT Academic Project | 2024

PHP, Laravel, MySQL

- Built an end-to-end inventory and sales management system supporting multi-user transactional workflows and dynamic reporting.
- Implemented role-segregated interfaces and an audit log, applying data integrity and access control principles in a commercial context.

Research Lead: AI-Powered Dyslexia Screening Tool | SLIIT Final Year Research Project | 2025 to 2026

Machine Learning, NLP, Python

- Led a multidisciplinary team in designing and prototyping a machine learning-powered dyslexia screening application using NLP-based text analysis.
- Managed the full research lifecycle from literature review and dataset curation through to model evaluation and prototype delivery.

Technical Skills

Infrastructure and Systems	Development and Engineering
Active Directory and Group Policy (GPO) BitLocker Endpoint Encryption Windows Server Administration TCP/IP Networking and VLAN Fundamentals IT Asset and Licence Management Network Documentation and IP Management IT Service Support and Ticketing	MERN Stack (MongoDB, Express, React, Node.js) PHP and Laravel Framework Java (OOP and Backend Services) RESTful API Design MySQL and MongoDB Git and GitHub Python (Scripting) HTML5, CSS3, Tailwind CSS

5. Learning and Development Goals

This section outlines the learning priorities I have set for myself over the coming period, based on where I am now and where I want to be professionally. Rather than listing certifications I have already earned, I want to be honest about what I am still working toward and why each goal matters to me.

5.1 Microsoft Azure: Where I Am and Where I Am Going

Microsoft Azure: Current Status and Next Steps

I have not yet completed any formal Azure training or certification. That is something I am aware of and actively planning to address. My six months in the Digital Infrastructure Department gave me a practical grounding in on-premises systems, and now that I have moved into Managed Services, I see cloud knowledge becoming increasingly relevant to the work ahead.

My immediate goal is to work through the Microsoft Learn AZ-900 path and sit the Azure Fundamentals exam. From there, I plan to progress to AZ-104, which covers the administrator-level skills I will need to manage cloud environments in a professional capacity. I am planning to set up a free-tier Azure account to practise alongside the study material, so that what I learn does not stay theoretical.

The reason Azure matters to me is straightforward. The infrastructure work I have done so far has been on-premises. But the industry is clearly moving toward hybrid and cloud-first environments, and I want to be technically ready for that shift rather than catching up to it. Azure feels like the natural next step given the enterprise Microsoft environment I have already been working in.

5.2 Planned Certification Roadmap

Certification	Issuing Body	Target Date	Status
Microsoft Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900)	Microsoft	Late 2026	Planned
Azure Administrator Associate (AZ-104)	Microsoft	Early 2027	Planned
Cisco CCNA	Cisco	2027 to 2028	Planned
Azure Solutions Architect Expert (AZ-305)	Microsoft	2028 to 2029	Planned

5.3 Why This Direction

My background in development gave me a strong foundation in how software is built. My time in the Digital Infrastructure Department taught me how the systems underneath software are maintained and secured. The

logical next step is to connect those two areas through cloud infrastructure, where the lines between development and operations increasingly overlap.

The Managed Services environment I am moving into is a good setting for that growth. Managed services teams work closely with clients across different infrastructure configurations, which means exposure to a wider variety of systems and problems than a single internal department typically offers. I am entering it with a clear learning agenda and a genuine interest in making the most of what it has to offer.